

for handling of e-waste, the power to cancel an authorization, procedure for registration with the State Pollution Control Board, and the procedure for reduction of the use of hazardous substances in the manufacture of electrical and electronic equipment. The rules specify that: every producer of electrical and electronic equipment shall ensure that, new electrical or electronic equipment does not contain lead, mercury, hexavalent chromium, polybrominated biphenyls and polybrominated diphenyl ethers, provided that a maximum concentration value of 0.1% by weight in homogenous materials for the above mentioned substances and 0.01% by weight in homogenous materials for cadmium shall be permitted. The duties of the authorities, the necessity of an annual report, the transportation of e-waste and the categories of electrical and electronic equipment covered under the rules and the application formats and forms for applying for authorization in all aspects of dealing with e-waste are mentioned. The rules as mentioned earlier define the meaning of various words used and the responsibilities of the parties therein.

A 'Producer' means any person, irrespective of the selling technique used, manufactures and offers to sell electrical and electronic equipment under his own brand or offers to sell under his own brand, assembled equipment produced by other manufacturers and suppliers or offers to sell imported equipment.

The responsibilities of the 'producer' are the collection of the e-waste generated during the process of manufacture and channelizing it for recycling or disposal, collection of the e-waste generated from the 'end life' of their products in line with the principle of 'Extended Producer Responsibility' and send it to a registered 'dismantler' or recycler and ensure this by authorizing collection agencies. Setting up collection centres or take back systems either individually or collectively and financing and organizing to meet the costs involved in the sound management of the e-waste generated from the 'end life' of its own products and historical waste available from the date from which these rules came into force, the financing arrangement has to be transparent whether established individually or collectively as the case may be. According to the rules, the producer also has to provide contact details such as addresses/telephone numbers/helpline numbers of authorized collection centres to all consumers. Responsibilities also include creating awareness through the media and information booklets with the equipment, information on hazardous constituents, hazards of improper handling, accidental breakage or improper recycling, instruc-